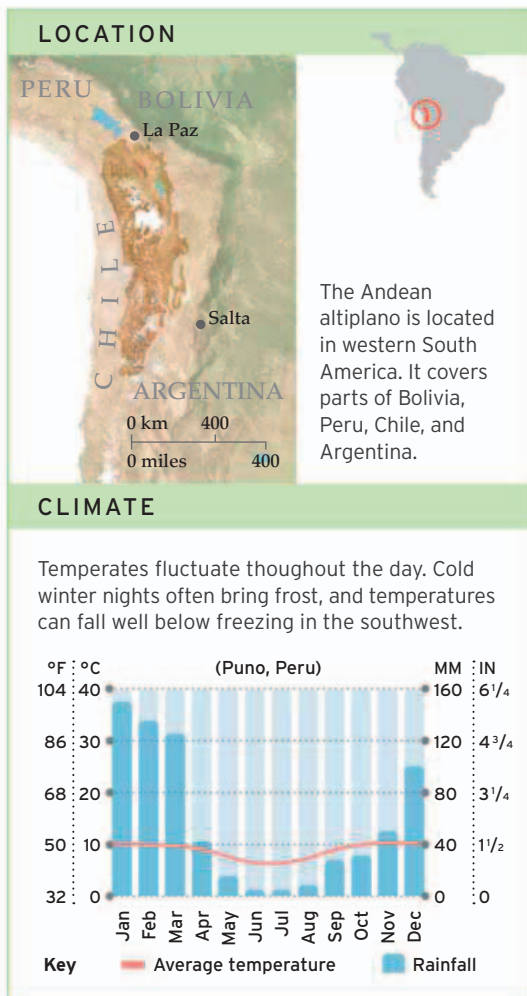




Culpeo

Pseudalopex culpaeus



The second largest wild canid in South America, the culpeo is also known as the Andean fox, a name that reflects many of its characteristics. Like most fox species, it is an opportunistic hunter, feeding on wild berries as well as rodents and introduced European hares and rabbits. It also takes young domestic livestock such as lambs occasionally, which brings it into conflict with farmers.

- ↔ 2–4 ft (0.6–1.2 m)
- ⚖ 11–30 lb (5–13.5 kg)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🐭 Rodents, hares, fruit, insects
- 🏠



◁ HOME IN THE ROCKS

Culpeos are usually solitary, but mated pairs stay together for up to five months, making dens in caves, which both parents guard from predators.

Northern viscacha

Lagidium peruanum

The northern viscacha resembles a long-tailed rabbit, but this high-altitude rodent is more closely related to chinchillas. Its soft, ultra-dense coat protects it from frigid temperatures, while thin-walled arteries help it to survive in the oxygen-depleted conditions of the high Andes.

- ↔ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)
- ⚖ 2–4 lb (0.9–1.8 kg)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🌱 Grass, lichen, moss
- 🏠



whiskers around 6 in (15 cm) long

▷ CLIFF DWELLER

Viscacha colonies are often located on steep cliffs, which provide protection from predators—as well as being prime spots for basking.



COVETED FUR

The long-tailed chinchilla's ultra-dense fur keeps it warm in the freezing temperatures of the high plateau. However, its fur became its downfall because chinchillas were trapped by hunters for the pet and fur trade. They are now critically endangered.

DRY season lasts eight months

CHINCHILLA